6. DEMONSTRATE LINUX PRIVILEGE ESCALATION

DATE: 04/03/2026

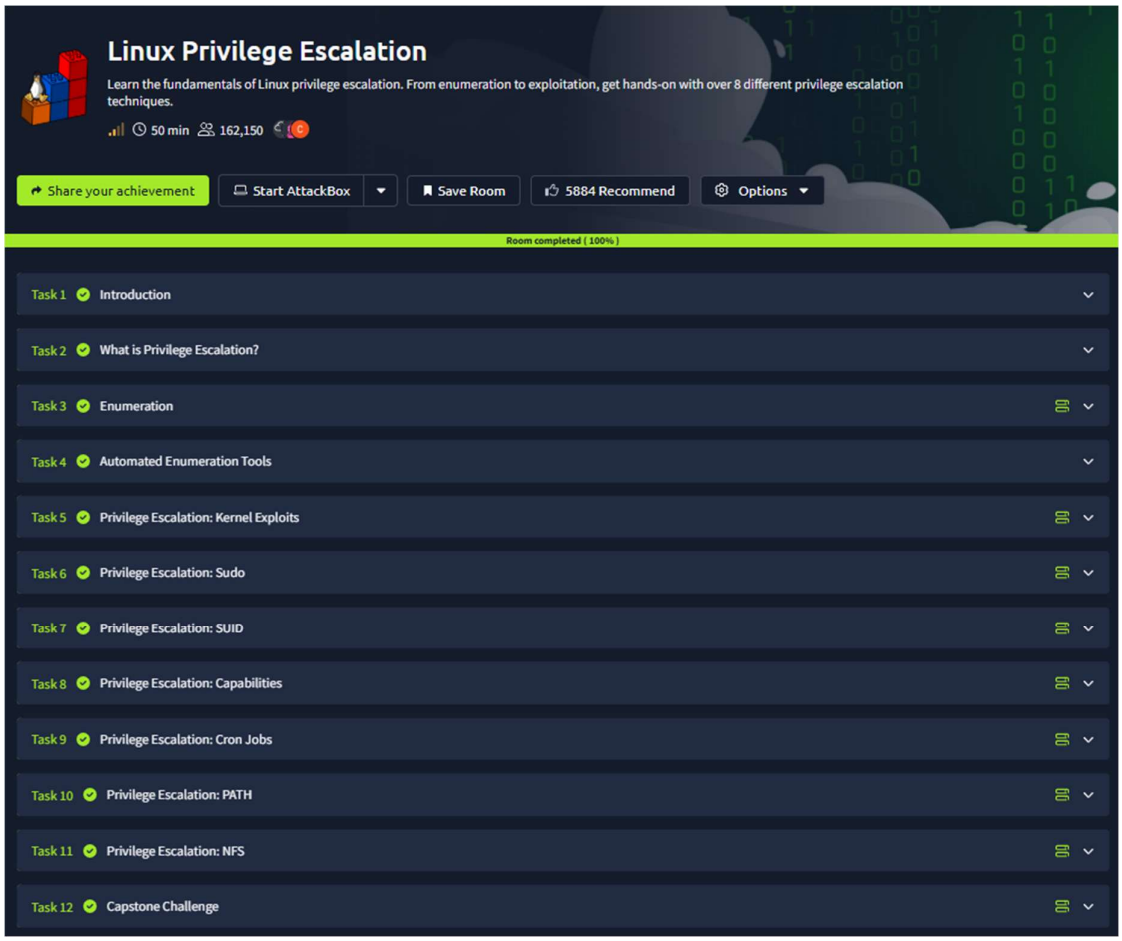
Aim:

To learn the fundamentals of Linux privilege escalation ,from enumeration to exploitation, get hands-on with over 8 different privilege escalation techniques.

Procedure:

1. Log into TryHackMe and open the Linux Privilege Escalation room.
2. Perform enumeration to gather system and user information.
3. Identify potential misconfigurations and vulnerabilities.
4. Study common techniques such as SUID, cron jobs, and PATH manipulation.
5. Analyze how to exploit these weaknesses to gain elevated privileges.
6. Complete the tasks and answer the questions in the room.
7. Review the summary and confirm completion.

Tasks:



TASK 1 - Introduction

Answer the questions below

Read the above.

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 2 – What is Privilege Escalation?

Answer the questions below

Read the above.

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 3 – Enumeration

Answer the questions below

What is the hostname of the target system?

wade7363 ✓ Correct Answer

What is the Linux kernel version of the target system?

3.13.0-24-generic ✓ Correct Answer

What Linux is this?

Ubuntu 14.04 LTS ✓ Correct Answer

What version of the Python language is installed on the system?

2.7.6 ✓ Correct Answer

What vulnerability seem to affect the kernel of the target system? (Enter a CVE number)

CVE-2015-1328 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 4 – Automated Enumeration Tools

Answer the questions below

Install and try a few automated enumeration tools on your local Linux distribution

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 5 – Privilege Escalation – Kernel Exploits

Answer the questions below

find and use the appropriate kernel exploit to gain root privileges on the target system.

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag1.txt file?

THM-28392872729920 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 6 – Privilege Escalation : Sudo

Answer the questions below

How many programs can the user "karen" run on the target system with sudo rights?

3 ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag2.txt file?

THM-402028394 ✓ Correct Answer

How would you use Nmap to spawn a root shell if your user had sudo rights on nmap?

sudo nmap --interactive ✓ Correct Answer

What is the hash of frank's password?

$6$2.sUUDsOLIpXKxcr$eImtgFExyr2ls4jsghdD3DHLHHP9X50Iv.jNmwo/BJpphrPRJWjelWEz2HH.joV14aDEwW1c3CahzB1uaq(✓ Correct Answer

TASK 7 – Privilege Escalation : SUID

Answer the questions below

Which user shares the name of a great comic book writer?

gerryconway ✓ Correct Answer

What is the password of user2?

Password1 ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag3.txt file?

THM-3847834 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 8 – Privilege Escalation :. Capabilities

Answer the questions below

Complete the task described above on the target system

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

How many binaries have set capabilities?

6 ✓ Correct Answer

What other binary can be used through its capabilities?

view ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag4.txt file?

THM-9349843 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 9 – Privilege Escalation : Cron Jobs

Answer the questions below

How many user-defined cron jobs can you see on the target system?

4 ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag5.txt file?

THM-383000283 ✓ Correct Answer

What is Matt's password?

123456 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 10 – Privilege Escalation : PATH

Answer the questions below

What is the odd folder you have write access for?

/home/murdoch ✓ Correct Answer

Exploit the $PATH vulnerability to read the content of the flag6.txt file.

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag6.txt file?

THM-736628929 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 11 – Privilege Escalation : NFS

Answer the questions below

How many mountable shares can you identify on the target system?

3 ✓ Correct Answer

How many shares have the "no_root_squash" option enabled?

3 ✓ Correct Answer

Gain a root shell on the target system

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag7.txt file?

THM-89384012 ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 12 – Capstone Challenge

Answer the questions below

What is the content of the flag1.txt file?

THM-42828719920544 ✓ Correct Answer

What is the content of the flag2.txt file?

THM-168824782390238 ✓ Correct Answer

Result:

Thus the TryHackMe room Linux Privilege Escalation was completed successfully.